Ralph Collum

803.618.0082 | ralph.collum@sudomail.com | West Columbia, SC

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/ralph-collum-49b6b415

Professional Summary

Cybersecurity Leader | Mentor | Instructor | Security Strategist

Dynamic and results-driven cybersecurity leader with over 19 years of experience advancing information security strategy, training, and risk management. Proven record of leading cybersecurity initiatives that protect organizational assets, enhance compliance, and elevate operational resilience.

As a mentor and educator, I've guided hundreds of professionals and students toward certification and career success, fostering the next generation of cybersecurity talent. I combine strategic leadership, technical depth, and teaching excellence to build strong security cultures across enterprises and communities.

Key strengths include security architecture, vulnerability management, penetration testing, risk governance, and cybersecurity education. Passionate about empowering people, developing future leaders, and advancing cybersecurity maturity across the public and private sectors.

Certifications

- CISSP – Certified Information Systems Security Professional
- CompTIA Security+, CySA+, SecurityX, and Pentest+
- CCNA: CyberOps
- EC-Council Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)
- Certified Hacking Forensics Investigator (CHFI)
- Certified Security Analyst (ECSA)
- Certified Network Defender (CND)

Full documentation available upon request

Professional Experience

Training Concepts – Columbia, SC

Senior Cybersecurity Instructor | Architect | Mentor
2006 – Present

- Lead cybersecurity instructor and mentor, designing and delivering advanced training programs for CompTIA and EC-Council certifications.

- Mentored and coached 500+ cybersecurity professionals, guiding them through certification preparation, technical mastery, and career transitions.
- Partnered with executive leaders and enterprise clients to build cybersecurity maturity frameworks, including vulnerability management, incident response, and business continuity programs.
- Conducted complex penetration testing engagements to identify and remediate security gaps across diverse environments.
- Contribute to the cybersecurity community as co-organizer of OWASP-Columbia and President of (ISC)^2 Midlands Chapter.
- Frequent speaker at B-Sides and industry conferences on cybersecurity leadership, penetration testing, and professional development.
- Developed custom cybersecurity curricula for corporate clients to strengthen practical defense capabilities and internal security awareness.

Collum Computer Industries – Columbia, SC

CEO | CISO | CTO
2000 – 2006

- Founded and led a security consulting firm focused on strategic cybersecurity, IT governance, and digital risk management.
- Oversaw design and implementation of network security architectures including firewalls, intrusion detection systems, and enterprise security controls.
- Directed business impact analyses, disaster recovery, and continuity programs, ensuring organizational resilience.
- Conducted security audits and incident investigations, collaborating with law enforcement to support successful prosecutions of cybercrime cases.
- Led a team of engineers and analysts, mentoring junior staff in secure design, penetration testing, and ethical hacking best practices.

Leadership & Mentorship Highlights

- Guided cybersecurity learners through structured study plans, mock exams, and career coaching — over 85% achieved certification success.
- Serve as (ISC)^2 Midlands Columbia Chapter President and OWASP-Columbia Co-Organizer, promoting cybersecurity awareness and professional growth.
- Regularly contribute to cybersecurity workshops, B-Sides conferences, and speaking events to inspire professionals to pursue leadership and technical excellence.

Areas of Expertise

Security Leadership | Risk Management | Vulnerability Assessment | Penetration Testing
Incident Response | Business Continuity | Security Architecture | Mentorship & Training
Cloud Security | Microsoft 365 & SharePoint | Strategic Planning | Community Development

Technical Proficiencies

Operating Systems: Windows Server (2003–2022), CentOS, Ubuntu, Kali Linux, macOS
Languages: PowerShell, Python, Bash, Ruby, Perl
Security Tools: Metasploit, Nmap, Nessus, Wireshark, Burp Suite, Recon-NG, Nexpose, John the Ripper
Applications: Microsoft 365, SharePoint Server/Online, Office Suite (2003–2021)

Education

University of South Carolina – Columbia, SC
Bachelor of Science, Chemistry (2000)

References

Available upon request.